

# BERO TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED

## WORKER RESPONSIBILITY POLICY

This Worker Responsibility Policy explicitly defines the strict operational parameters governing the relationship between Bero and the Service Professionals. Its primary legal objective is to ensure compliance, mitigate worker misclassification risks, and uphold the decentralized integrity of the marketplace.

### 1. Affirmation of Independent Contractor Status

- 1.1.** In response to increasing judicial scrutiny regarding the classification of gig-workers in India, Bero explicitly structures its operations to preserve the true autonomy of the Service Professional.
- 1.2. No Exclusivity or Restraint of Trade:** Service Professionals operate as independent commercial entities. They are free to provide services on competing digital platforms, run their own independent businesses, and solicit offline clients simultaneously without restriction.
- 1.3. Absolute Operational Flexibility:** Service Professionals maintain total control over their availability. Bero does not mandate minimum working hours, does not enforce mandatory shifts, and does not penalize workers for periods of inactivity.
- 1.4. Right to Reject:** While the Bipartite Graph Matching Algorithm offers Service Requests based on complex utility calculations, the Service Professional possesses the absolute right to accept or reject any dispatch. Bero does not impose punitive, employment-style sanctions for rejecting a dispatch. (However, the algorithm's Gale-Shapley stability model naturally optimizes future matches toward highly responsive participants to maintain network liquidity).

### 2. Taxation and Statutory Liabilities

- 2.1.** As independent micro-entrepreneurs, Service Professionals are solely and exclusively responsible for calculating, reporting, and remitting all applicable direct and indirect taxes to the respective Indian tax authorities. This includes Income Tax and Goods and Services Tax (GST), where the worker's turnover exceeds the statutory threshold.
- 2.2.** Bero acts purely as an Electronic Commerce Operator (ECO). Bero will deduct Tax Collected at Source (TCS) under the CGST Act, 2017, or Tax Deducted at Source (TDS) under Section 194-O of the Income Tax Act, 1961, strictly where mandated by law, and remit the same to the government.
- 2.3.** Bero does not issue Form 16s (salary certificates) and does not make contributions to the Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) or Employees' State Insurance (ESI), as there is no employer-employee relationship.

### **3. Provision of Tools, Equipment, and Insurance**

- 3.1. Tools and Infrastructure:** Bero provides software infrastructure. Service Professionals are entirely responsible for procuring, maintaining, and funding their own tools, vehicles, smartphones, internet data plans, and specific trade equipment required to safely and effectively execute the Service Requests. Bero does not provide uniforms or branded equipment that would imply an agency relationship.
- 3.2. Insurance Responsibility:** Bero does not provide worker's compensation, health insurance, or commercial vehicle insurance. Service Professionals are strongly advised to procure their own comprehensive life, health, and professional liability insurance policies to cover bodily injury or property damage risks sustained during the course of fulfilling a booking.

### **4. Safety, Conduct, and Legal Compliance**

- 4.1.** Service Professionals warrant that they shall comply with all local, state, and central laws while rendering services. This includes acquiring and maintaining any necessary municipal trade licenses, vocational certifications, or permits required for their specific trade.
- 4.2.** Service Professionals must adhere to all safety regulations and standard operating procedures pertinent to their trade (e.g., electrical safety standards, structural guidelines).
- 4.3.** Any engagement in acts of harassment, physical violence, theft, or intoxication while on a Client's premises constitutes a severe material breach. Such acts will result in immediate and permanent deactivation from the Bero platform and the immediate reporting of the individual to relevant law enforcement authorities.

### **5. KYC and Verification Rights**

To ensure the safety of the marketplace, Bero reserves the right to conduct comprehensive background checks, identity verifications (via Aadhaar, PAN, and facial recognition liveness checks), and criminal record assessments prior to onboarding a Service Professional, and periodically thereafter. Service Professionals explicitly consent to these verifications. Bero may temporarily suspend a worker's access to the Platform pending the resolution of any discrepancies identified during these audits.